予 想 問 題　第 1 回

前 期 日 程　対 策

英 語 問 題

東北大学（全学部共通）の出題形式に準拠 ／ 問題

注　意

1. 問題部分と解答用紙で構成されている（問題部分 1〜10ページ・解答用紙 11〜12ページ）。答えは解答用紙の決められた欄に書くこと。
2. 試験時間の目安は100分。大問はⅠ〜Ⅳの4題。
3. 配点は Ⅰ 60点・Ⅱ 50点・Ⅲ 40点・Ⅳ 50点（計200点）。本予想問題が独自に定めた配点である。
4. 本冊子の英文・日本文・設問はすべてオリジナルである。登場する人物・団体・地名は架空。

東北大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。
本冊子は過去の出題形式を分析して作成した練習用の教材です。

I 長文読解（配点 60点）

以下の英文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

For most of human history, an object that stopped working was not the end of a story but the beginning of a new chapter. A torn coat was patched, a cracked bowl was glued, and a chair with a loose leg was carried to someone in the village who (ア)knew how to make it stand firmly again. Repair was so ordinary that hardly anyone thought of it as a skill worth discussing; it was simply part of owning things. Families kept boxes of buttons, nails and spare pieces of cloth, not because they were poor, but because it seemed foolish to throw away anything that might one day be useful. Today, in many wealthy societies, the situation looks very different. When the screen of a phone breaks or a kettle stops heating, the first question people ask is often not “Who can fix this?” but “How much does a new one cost?”

This change did not happen by accident. Over the past century, manufacturing has become so efficient that many goods (イ)is now cheaper to replace than to mend. Products, meanwhile, have grown far more complex. A radio built seventy years ago could be opened with an ordinary screwdriver, and its parts (ウ)were large enough to be seen and handled by anyone curious enough to look inside. Many modern devices, by contrast, are sealed with glue, held together by unusual screws, or built around tiny *components that cannot be replaced one by one. Even when repair is technically possible, the information needed to carry it out is often (エ)kept from the very people who own the device. The result is a world in which (1)the ability to fix things has quietly moved out of ordinary hands.

(I), something important is lost when repair disappears from everyday life. The most obvious loss is economic and environmental. Every object that is thrown away rather than mended must be replaced by a new one, and making that new object requires raw materials, energy and transport, much of which leaves no trace on the price tag. (2)A society that repairs little is therefore one that must keep producing a great deal, not because people need more things, but because the things they already have are treated as disposable the moment they fail. Seen in this light, the cheapness of replacement is partly an illusion: the cost has not disappeared but has simply been moved somewhere we cannot easily see it. Someone, somewhere, still pays it, whether as polluted rivers, overflowing landfills or the exhaustion of resources that future generations will need.

Yet resources are not all that is lost. Repairing something demands a particular kind of attention. To fix a bicycle chain or a dripping tap, a person has to look closely, form a guess about what has gone wrong, test that guess, and try again (オ)when the first attempt fails. Very often the first guess is wrong, and the second is only partly right. Yet each failure narrows the

possibilities, and the person gradually builds a clearer picture of the object than any instruction book could have provided. This slow cycle of observation and correction teaches patience, and it builds a practical sense of how the material world actually behaves. People who repair things often say that they truly understand an object only after they have taken it apart and put it back together. (3)In this sense, a broken object is not merely a problem to be solved; it is also an invitation to learn.

There is a social side to repair as well. In the past, fixing things frequently brought people together. Neighbours lent one another tools, older relatives showed younger ones how to sew on a button or sharpen a knife, and small repair shops were places (カ)where news and advice were exchanged as freely as spare parts. When repair moves into distant service centres, or vanishes altogether, these modest connections (キ)grow weaker. A teenager who has never watched anyone mend a shirt is unlikely to think of mending one, and a town without a single repair shop offers few places where such skills can even be seen. (II), knowledge that was once handed down from person to person is in danger of being forgotten, because skills that are not practised are rarely remembered for long.

In recent years, however, signs of change have appeared. In a number of towns, volunteers (ク)have begun organizing regular gatherings at which residents can bring broken lamps, toasters, clothes and toys and work on them side by side with people who have the necessary skills. Participants often say that the most valuable thing they take home is not the repaired object but the confidence to attempt the next repair on their own. Some governments have begun to debate rules that would require manufacturers (ケ)making spare parts and repair manuals available for several years after a product is sold. (4)What is striking about these efforts is how sharply the attitudes they encourage differ from the ones the market has long rewarded. Where the market has praised speed, novelty and convenience, those who promote repair value care, *durability and the gradual *accumulation of skill.

None of this means that we should return to a world in which every household mends its own shoes. Specialization has genuine benefits, and not every object deserves the hours it would take to restore. But it does suggest that the question “Can this be fixed?” deserves a place in our thinking once more. If (5)[(A) asking (B) habit (C) that (D) ourselves (E) we (F) of (G) make (H) question (I) a] before buying something new, we may begin to see the objects around us less as temporary purchases and more as things (コ)worth looking after. That shift in perspective, small as it may seem, could change how much we buy, how much we throw away, and how connected we feel to the people who help keep our belongings working.

*components 部品
*durability 耐久性

*accumulation　蓄積

問 1　下線部(ア)〜(オ)と(カ)〜(コ)には，文法的に正しくない箇所がそれぞれ一つずつ含まれている。該当する記号を書け。

問 2　下線部(1)で筆者が述べている内容として最適なものを(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) People have quietly stopped caring whether the things they own work properly.
(B) Fixing things has gradually become something that ordinary owners are less and less able to do themselves.
(C) Most owners now prefer to repair their devices in secret rather than ask for help.
(D) Repair shops have moved away from cities, so people must travel far to have things fixed.

問 3　空所[I]を補うのに最適な語句を(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) In short
(B) For example
(C) Even so
(D) Likewise

問 4　下線部(2)を和訳せよ。

問 5　下線部(3)の意味するところを，本文の内容に沿って日本語で説明せよ。

問 6　空所[II]を補うのに最適な語句を(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) In contrast
(B) Despite this
(C) Instead
(D) As a result

問 7　下線部(4)で筆者が大きく異なると考えている二つのものは何か。本文に沿って日本語で具体的に述べよ。

問 8　下線部(5)の［　］内の語を正しく並べて意味の通る英文にするとき，2番目・5番目・7番目にくる語の記号を書け。各語は一度ずつ用いること。

II 長文読解（配点 50点）

以下の英文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

Few experiences are as universally disliked as waiting. We wait for buses that are late, for web pages that refuse to load, for a doctor who is running behind schedule, and for replies to messages we sent hours ago. In each case, the minutes seem to stretch, and our patience (a)wears thin far sooner than we expect. What is curious is that (1)the same length of time can feel completely different depending on the circumstances in which we spend it. Ten minutes in a pleasant conversation pass almost unnoticed; ten minutes staring at a closed door can feel like half an hour.

Part of the explanation lies in where our attention goes. When we are (b)absorbed in an activity, we rarely check the clock, and time slips by without our noticing. When we are waiting, by contrast, there is often nothing to occupy the mind except the waiting itself. ［ ① ］ Each glance at a watch reminds us that the thing we want has not yet arrived, and so the attention we pay to time actually makes it seem to move more slowly. This is why people who design public spaces have long tried to give those who wait something to look at, read or do.

Uncertainty makes matters worse. A wait of fifteen minutes is far easier to bear when we know it will last fifteen minutes than when we have no idea whether it will end in two minutes or in an hour. ［ ② ］ Not knowing turns a simple delay into a small source of *anxiety, because we cannot plan, relax or decide whether to give up and leave. A short message announcing that the train will arrive in twelve minutes does nothing to make the train faster, yet it changes the experience of everyone on the platform. The delay is the same; what has changed is that people can now fit it into their picture of the day. Similarly, a receptionist at a clinic who says “about forty minutes” often makes patients calmer than one who says nothing at all.

Fairness matters too, perhaps more than we usually admit. Most people will accept a long wait with reasonable calm as long as they believe that everyone is being treated equally. What (c)provokes real anger is the sense that someone else has been allowed to jump ahead without good reason. ［ ③ ］ In this respect, a queue is not just a practical arrangement for serving people one by one; it is a small social agreement, and people react strongly when they feel it has been broken. (2)Someone who has waited patiently for twenty minutes may forgive the delay itself, but not the stranger who walks straight to the front.

If waiting is so unpleasant, it is tempting to conclude that the ideal world would be one in which we never had to wait at all. Modern technology seems to be moving us in that direction. Films begin the moment we choose them, goods arrive at our door within a day, and questions that once required a trip to the library can be answered in seconds. Much of this is undeniably

useful. A parent who can order medicine at midnight or a student who can check a fact instantly is better off than someone who had to wait days for the same result. Yet it is worth asking whether something is lost when every gap in our day is filled and every wish is met at once.

One possibility is that waiting, at least in moderate amounts, gives value to the things we wait for. A meal that has been slowly prepared, a letter from a friend in a distant country, or a holiday that has been planned for months often brings a pleasure that is partly made of *anticipation. The days before the event are not simply empty time to be endured; they are filled with imagining, preparing and looking forward. Children counting the days until a birthday understand this instinctively: the counting itself adds to the fun. Remove the wait entirely, and (3)[(A) much (B) of (C) we (D) the (E) that (F) enjoyment (G) might (H) we (I) lose (J) feel] before the experience even begins.

Waiting may also offer something more modest but no less important: a pause. In a life crowded with tasks and notifications, the few minutes spent in a queue or at a bus stop are among the rare moments in which nothing is demanded of us. No one expects an answer from us, no task is waiting to be finished, and for once we are free to be slightly bored. Some people use these moments to *daydream, to notice the street around them, or simply to let their thoughts settle. When we fill every such gap automatically with a screen, we may gain a little information, but we also give up a chance to rest our minds. It may be no coincidence that people often report having their best ideas while doing nothing in particular.

None of this is an argument for long, pointless delays. A hospital that keeps patients waiting for hours, or an office that makes people return again and again to complete a simple form, is failing them, and the frustration they feel is entirely justified. Reducing such delays is a responsibility that organizations should take seriously. The point is rather that waiting is not a single thing. Some waits are wasteful and should be reduced; others are part of what makes an experience meaningful. Learning to tell the difference, and perhaps to treat a few idle minutes as an opportunity rather than an *ordeal, may be a skill worth developing in an age that has made (d)impatience so easy.

*anxiety 不安
*anticipation 期待
*daydream 空想にふける
*ordeal 苦しい試練

問 1 下線部(1)のような違いが生じる理由として筆者が挙げていることを，本文に沿って二つ，日本語で手短に述べよ。

問 2 下線部(2)が具体的に表している内容を，本文に沿って日本語で説明せよ。

問 3　下線部(3)の［　］内の語を正しく並べて意味の通る英文にするとき，3番目・6番目・9番目にくる語の記号を書け。各語は一度ずつ用いること。

問 4　本文中の空所［①］～［③］を補うのに最適な文を(A)～(C)のうちからそれぞれ一つ選び，その記号を書け。各選択肢は一度ずつ用いること。

(A) The end point is what allows the mind to accept the wait.
(B) We become, in a sense, observers of our own impatience.
(C) Even a brief delay feels intolerable once it seems unjust.

問 5　本文の内容から推し量れることとして適当なものを(A)～(E)のうちから二つ選び，その記号を書け。

(A) Telling waiting passengers when the train will come may make them calmer even though the train is not any earlier.
(B) The writer claims that modern technology has made waiting completely unnecessary in daily life.
(C) People generally become angrier about the length of a wait than about whether others are treated equally.
(D) The writer suggests that some of the pleasure of an event can come from the period before it happens.
(E) The writer recommends that hospitals make patients wait longer so that they can rest their minds.

問 6　下線部(a)～(d)の文脈上の意味に最も近い語句を，それぞれ(A)～(D)のうちから一つ選び，その記号を書け。

(a) wears thin	(A) grows stronger	(B) becomes visible	(C) stays calm	(D) runs out
(b) absorbed	(A) deeply involved	(B) slightly tired	(C) quietly bored	(D) easily confused
(c) provokes	(A) prevents	(B) reduces	(C) causes	(D) hides
(d) impatience	(A) eagerness to wait	(B) inability to wait calmly	(C) fear of the future	(D) lack of interest

III　会話文・意見論述（配点 40点）

After a seminar on money and technology, Professor Ashcombe of the Faculty of Economics stays behind to talk with two students, Ryota and Ingrid. Go through their conversation and then deal with tasks 1) and 2) that follow it.

Professor Ashcombe: Thanks for staying, both of you; in today's seminar I described how quickly payments in many countries have shifted from coins and notes to cards and phones. Some economists predict that cash will be almost gone within a generation, while others think it will survive in a smaller role, and before you leave I'd like to hear where you stand.

Ryota: Honestly, I hardly ever carry cash now: I pay for the train, my lunch, even my share of a dinner with friends using my phone. It's quicker, and I can see exactly where my money goes, because every purchase is recorded in an app. When I do have coins, they just sit in a jar on my desk. I think Japan should move toward a fully cashless system without delay.

Professor Ashcombe: That's a common view among students, and businesses often agree with you. Handling cash is surprisingly (1)costly: shops have to count it, store it safely and carry it to the bank, and all of that takes staff time. Ingrid, though, you look less convinced by that argument.

Ingrid: I am, although I use cards myself; what worries me is the people who can't or don't want to. My grandmother, for example, has never owned a smartphone, and she finds card machines confusing. If every shop stopped accepting cash, she would struggle to buy even a loaf of bread. And it isn't only older people who would suffer, since some visitors from abroad, or people without a bank account, depend on cash too.

Professor Ashcombe: That's a serious concern, and in countries where cash use has fallen sharply, there have been arguments about whether shops should be obliged to keep accepting it. Ryota, how would you respond to Ingrid's point?

Ryota: I understand the problem, but I think it's temporary. Technology keeps getting simpler, and the government could help people who need support, for instance by offering free lessons or simple prepaid cards. We shouldn't keep an old system just because some people haven't adapted yet.

Ingrid: But it's not just about learning; what happens when the whole system fails? Last year there was a power cut in my hometown after a storm, and for two days none of the card readers worked. People who had cash at home could still buy food and water from the small shops that stayed open, while everyone else simply had to wait. A society that relies entirely on electronic

payments is (2)vulnerable in a way we don't notice until something goes wrong.

Professor Ashcombe: That's an important point about resilience, and there's also the matter of privacy to consider. Every electronic payment leaves a record, and those records can reveal a great deal about a person's habits, health and relationships. Some people find that convenient; others find it rather (3)intrusive.

Ryota: I suppose I've never really thought about who can see my payment history; I just assumed it was safe.

Ingrid: That's exactly what worries me, because with cash, nobody knows what I bought unless I tell them.

Professor Ashcombe: Of course, cash has its own problems: it can be lost or stolen, and it's easier to use for illegal purposes because it leaves no trace. In short, neither system is perfect, and many economists would say the real issue is not cash versus no cash, but how to balance convenience, safety and fairness. Some propose a mixed approach: encourage digital payments, but make sure cash remains available for those who need it.

Ryota: That sounds sensible, but wouldn't keeping both systems be expensive? Someone has to pay for maintaining cash machines and printing money.

Professor Ashcombe: Yes, and that cost is one reason some banks are closing branches and cash machines, especially in rural areas. It's a genuine (4)trade-off, and nobody has a simple solution. Well, I'm afraid we have to stop here for today. For next week, please read the two short articles I've uploaded; they take opposite positions on this question.

1)

For each underlined expression (1)–(4), pick the option from (A)–(D) closest to its meaning in this conversation.

(1) costly	(A) popular	(B) expensive	(C) careless	(D) slow
(2) vulnerable	(A) highly efficient	(B) strongly protected	(C) easily harmed	(D) widely trusted
(3) intrusive	(A) helpful and welcome	(B) harmless in most cases	(C) easy to ignore	(D) unpleasantly invading one’s private life
(4) trade-off	(A) a balance between gains and losses	(B) a business agreement	(C) a sudden change	(D) a simple mistake

2)

Which of the two students, Ryota or Ingrid, is more convincing to you? Explain your view with two supporting reasons, using between 60 and 80 English words.

Ⅳ　日本文の英訳・語句整序（配点 50点）

以下の日本文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

職場や教室で交わされる雑談は，しばしば時間の無駄だと考えられている。天気の話や週末の出来事についての短いやりとりは，仕事や勉強の中身とは直接かかわりがないからだ。(1)しかし，雑談がまったくない集団では，困ったことがあっても誰にも相談できず，小さな問題が大きくなるまで放っておかれることが少なくない。

雑談の意味は，情報を伝えることよりも，互いの様子を知り，声をかけやすい関係をつくっておくことにあるのだろう。(2)実際，毎日言葉を交わしている相手に自分の失敗を打ち明けることは，それほど難しくない。一方，ふだんほとんど話さない相手には，ささいな質問をするのにも勇気がいる。

もちろん，相手の都合も考えずに長々と話し続けるのは迷惑である。(3)大切なのは，雑談を義務にすることではなく，誰もが気軽に話しかけられる雰囲気を保つことである。

問 1　下線部(1)を英文にせよ。

問 2　下線部(2)を下のような英文で表すとき，(A)〜(J)から8つを選んで正しく並べ，空所(①)(②)(③)にくるものの記号を書け。各選択肢は一度ずつ用いること。

In fact, (　　) (①) (　　) (　　) (②) (　　) (③) (　　) every day is not that difficult.

(A) admitting	(B) failures	(C) people	(D) talk	(E) to
(F) our	(G) whom	(H) we	(I) which	(J) with

問 3　下線部(3)を下のような英文で表すとき，(A)〜(J)から8つを選んで正しく並べ，空所(①)(②)(③)にくるものの記号を書け。各選択肢は一度ずつ用いること。

What matters is not making small talk an obligation but (①) (　　) (　　) (②) (　　) (　　) (③) (　　) to speak to others.

(A) an	(B) anyone	(C) atmosphere	(D) feels	(E) free
(F) in	(G) keeping	(H) what	(I) which	(J) whom

解答用紙　予想問題 第1回

受験番号・氏名欄は省略。記号は (A) のように書く。

I

問 1	[　　] [　　]
問 2	[　　]
問 3	[　　]
問 4	
問 5	
問 6	[　　]
問 7	
問 8	2番目 [　　]　5番目 [　　]　7番目 [　　]

II

問 1	
問 2	
問 3	3番目 [　　]　6番目 [　　]　9番目 [　　]
問 4	[①] [　]　[②] [　]　[③] [　]
問 5	[　　] [　　]
問 6	(a) [　]　(b) [　]　(c) [　]　(d) [　]

解答用紙（III・IV）

III

1) (1) [　　] (2) [　　] (3) [　　] (4) [　　]

III 2)（60〜80語）

20語

40語

60語

80語

IV

問 1

問 2 ① [　　] ② [　　] ③ [　　]

問 3 ① [　　] ② [　　] ③ [　　]

奥付

予想問題 第1回　英語　問題

対象：東北大学 前期日程 英語（全学部共通）の受験準備

作成：学習アプリ マナトビ 編集部（2026年10月）

作成方法：2024〜2026年度の出題形式・語数・難易度を分析し，英文・日本文・設問をすべて新たに書き下ろした。

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